Gustavo Venturelli

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November 2026

Positions

Stetson University - 2025-Current
Assistant Professor of Political Science
Co-Director, Center for Public Opinion Research
Affiliated Faculty, Latin American and Latino Studies
DeLand, FL

Team Populism - 2025-Current
Researcher

ReDem - 2025-Current
Researcher

Central European University - 2024-25
Postdoctoral Researcher, Democracy Institute
OSUN Forum on Democracy and Development
Populism, Ideology, and Discourse in the Global South Hub
Budapest, Hungary

Skidmore College - 2023-24
Visiting Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science
Affiliated Faculty, Latin American, Caribbean, and Latinxs Studies Program
Saratoga Springs, NY

Yeshiva University - Spring 2023
Adjunct Professor, Department of Political Science
New York, NY

Education

Degrees

2023
PhD in Political Science, **University of Sao Paulo**, Sao Paulo, Brazil.
Dissertation: *From Populist Promises to Democratic Threats: Brazil's Political Trajectory.* ***2024 CAPES Thesis Award***.
Committee: Paolo Ricci (University of Sao Paulo), Fernando Limongi (Univeristy of Sao Paulo), Lúcio Rennó (University of Brasilia), and Pedro Ribeiro (Federal University of Sao Carlos)

2018
M.A in Political Sociology, **Federal University of Santa Catarina**, Florianopolis, Brazil

2016
B.A in Social Sciences, **Federal University of Santa Catarina**, Florianopolis, Brazil

Publications

Peer Reviewed Papers

2026

When Populism? Consistent and Opportunistic Populist Communication in the 2022 Brazilian Presidential Elections. (with Paolo Ricci, Guilherme Tiengo, and Raphaela Velho) (*Political Communication*, 0(0), pp. 1-29)

Populismo e trabalhismo na historiografia brasileira: uma reconciliação necessária. *Revista de História, 185, pp. 1-32.* (with Paolo Ricci and Jaqueline Zulini).

2024

Are There Populist Parties in Brazil? An Analysis of Elections Manifestos in Presidential Campaigns (2010 - 2022). *Pary Politics, 31(4), pp. 739–750*

2023

Connections Between Populism and Nationalism: Evidence from Jair Bolsonaro's Speeches. *Nations and Nationalism*, 29(3):1057-1075. (with Paolo Ricci).

2020

Abrindo caixas-pretas: contribuições metodológicas de Jon Elster às ciências sociais. *Mediações*, 25(2):393-411.

2017

Da representação à participação: uma inflexão entre autores representativistas. *Em Debate*, 17:84-106.

Invited Participations

2023

International Constellations of the Populist Radical-Right: An Analysis of Jair Bolsonaro's International Speeches (2019 - 2020). In: Lacatus, Corina, Georg Löffmann, and Gustav Meibauer. *Vox Populi: Populist Communication and Performative Leadership in International Politics*. London: Palgrave Macmillan. (with Eduardo R. Tamaki)

Loudmouth, Sharp Tongue: Incivility and Debasement in Brazil's President Jair Bolsonaro's YouTube Live Streams. In: Feldman, Ofer. *Debasing Political Rhetoric: Dissing Opponents, Journalists, and Minorities in Populist Leadership Communication*. New York: Springer. (with Eduardo R. Tamaki and Matheus G.M. Ferreira)

Current Research

Under Review

Creating Electoral Courts under Authoritarian Rule: The Brazilian Case (1932-1933). (with Paolo Ricci and Jaqueline Zulini)

Backsliding by Mistake? Rousseff's Impeachment and the Unintended Erosion of Brazilian Democracy. (with Flavia Batista da Silva)

As abordagens contemporâneas do populismo: Avanços, limitações, e a defesa de um conceito mínimo

Values, Not Grievances? Moral Conservatism, Authoritarian Attitudes, and the Far-Right Vote in Latin America (with Lucio Rennó and Renan Funtowicz)

In Preparation

Who Distrust Elections in Brazil? The 2018 and 2022 Elections. (with Filipe Faeti)

Left-Leaning Populist and Far-Right Leaders: The Causes of Democratic Erosion in Latin America

Perceptions of Electoral Integrity in Latin America: Polarized Losers and Misinformed Social Media Users (2010-2023) (with Paolo Ricci and Filipe Faeti)

Working Papers

Defending Democracy? Public Attitudes toward Militant Democracy in Brazil. (With Steven Smallpage and Paolo Ricci)

Leader and Party Affective Polarization in Brazil (with Julian Borba)

Do Strong Institutions Matter? EBMs Autonomy as a Moderator for Electoral Distrust Across Thirty Democracies (with Julian Borba and Paolo Ricci)

Mapping Impeachment Worldwide: An Original Dataset of Impeachment Activity and Executive Removal (1990–2026). *Original Dataset.* (with Flavia Batista da Silva and Ozlem Tuncel Gurlek)

Picking Experts: Criteria for Committee Assignments in the Brazilian Congress. (with Patricio Navia)

Teaching Experience

Course Instructor

Stetson University

2026-27

Fall 2026. POLI 325Q - Political Analysis (23 students)

Fall 2026. POLI 100 - Introduction to Political Science (30 students)

Fall 2026. POLI 396 - Research Apprenticeship (Center for Public Opinion Research) (8 students)

2025-26

Spring 2026. POLI 201 - Comparative Politics (26 students)

Spring 2026. POLI 100 - Introduction to Political Science (13 students)

Spring 2026. POLI 396 - Research Apprenticeship (Center for Public Opinion Research) (5 students)

Fall 2025. POLI 100 - Introduction to Political Science (24 students)

Fall 2025. POLI 201 - Comparative Politics (26 students)

Fall 2025. POLI 346 - Latin American Politics (6 students)

Skidmore College

2023-24

Summer 2024. PL 201-001 Principles of International Politics (5 students)

Spring 2024. PL 103-002 Introduction to Comparative and International Politics (28 students)

Spring 2024. PL 103-003 Introduction to Comparative and International Politics (13)

Spring 2024. PL 371-003 Populism and Democratic Backsliding in Latin America (3 students)

Fall 2023. PL 201-001 Principles of International Politics (17 students)

Fall 2023. POL 209-001. The Latin American Puzzle (13 students)

Fall 2023. POL 309-001. Latin America and the United States (4 students)

Yeshiva University

Spring 2023

Spring 2023. POL 1201. Politics Across Cultures: Introduction to Comparative Politics (16 students)

Spring 2023. POL 2298. Populism in Global Perspective (9 students)

Teaching Assistant

2020

Teaching Assistant Fellowship, University of Sao Paulo

2012-2014

Teaching Fellowship - PIBID, Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education Personnel (CAPES)

Conference Presentations

2026

Impeachment as a Driver of Backsliding: Evidence from Brazil. 2026 American Political Science Association Meeting & Exhibition. Boston, September 3-6. (With Flávia Batista da Silva)

Defending Democracy? Public Attitudes toward Militant Democracy in Brazil. 2026 American Political Science Association Meeting & Exhibition. Boston, September 3-6. (With Steven Smallpage and Paolo Ricci)

Values, Not Grievances? Moral Conservatism, Authoritarian Attitudes, and the Far-Right Vote in Latin America (with Lucio Rennó and Renan Funtowicz). 15th Meeting of the Brazilian Political Science Association, Belém, Brazil, July 30-31 (online) and August 3-6 (in-person).

Impeachment as a Two-Edged Sword: Dilma Rousseff Removal and Brazilian Democratic Backsliding. (with Flavia Batista da Silva) 83rd Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, April 23-26.

2025

Populism and Democratic Backsliding in Latin America: Evidence from Venezuela, Bolivia, and Ecuador. 2025 American Political Science Association Meeting & Exhibition. Vancouver, Canada, September 11-14.

Electoral Integrity in Latin America (2006 - 2023) (with Filipe Faeti). 11th Annual Conference of the World Association of Public Opinion Research Latin America, Florianópolis, Brazil, April 28-30.

Ideology and Attitudes Toward Foreign Intervention. (with Alexander Jensen). 82nd Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, April 3-6.

2024

Populism or Impeachment? Triggers of Brazilian Democratic Backsliding. 10th Annual Conference of the Austrian Political Science Association, Vienna, Austria, November 28-29.

Who Distrust Elections in Latin America? A Test of Five Hypotheses (with Filipe Faeti). 10th Annual Conference of the Austrian Political Science Association, Vienna, Austria, November 28-29.

Populism or Impeachment? Explaining the Brazilian Democratic Backsliding. 28th Annual Conference of Central European Political Science Association, Kaunas, Lithuania, Ocotober 3-4.

Who Distrusts Elections? Evidence from Brazil. (with Filipe Faeti). 81st Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, April 4-7.

Populism in a Nutshell: The 2022 Brazilian Election on Twitter. (with Paolo Ricci, Raphaela Martins Velho, Yuri Ferreira Nogueira and Guilherme Tiengo). 81st Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, April 4-7.

Who Distrust Elections? Evidence from Brazil. (with Filipe Faeti). XVII Congress of Brazilian Studies Association, San Diego, April 3-7.

2023

Brazilian Democratic Backsliding: What if Bolsonaro Had Not Been Elected? (with Eduardo R. Tamaki). 27th World Congress Political Science Association Conference, Buenos Aires, Argentina, July 15-19.

Who is the Most Populist Contemporary Brazilian President? An Ideational Approach to Collor, Lula, and Bolsonaro's Speeches. LASA 2023 - América Latina y el Caribe: Pensar, Representar y Luchar por los Derechos, Vancouver, Canada, May 24-27.

Mass Partisanship with Brazil's Workers' Party: Ideology, Grassroots Organizing, of Incumbency Status? (with Lucas Perello and Patricio Navia). 10th Latin American World Association for Public Opinion Research Congress, Oaxaca, Mexico, April 19-21.

Mass Partisanship with Brazil's Workers' Party: Ideology, Grassroots Organizing, of Incumbency Status? (with Lucas Perello and Patricio Navia). 80th Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, USA, April 13-16.

2022

Are There Populist Parties in Brazil? An Analysis of Presidential Electoral Platforms (2010 - 2018). 13th Brazilian Political Science Association Conference. Goiás, Brazil, September 20-23. (*Virtual*). (with Paolo Ricci)

Populism in Brazilian Party Manifestos: Presidential and Gubernatorial Elections (2010 - 2018). 79th Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, USA, April 7-10. (with Paolo Ricci, Guilherme Tiengo and Andre Viola)

Out With the Old, in With the New: A New Perspective to the Brazilian Populist Democracy (1946 - 1964). 79th Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, USA, April 7-10. (with Eduardo R. Tamaki)

Tweeters in Chief: Populism, Masculinity, and the Tweets of Donald Trump and Jair Bolsonaro. 79th Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, USA, April 7-10. (with Pedro dos Santos)

2021

Between Populism and Nationalism: An Ideational Approach on Jair Bolsonaro's Speeches (2019 - 2010). European Consortium for Political Research General Conference, August 30 - September 3, (*Virtual*). (with Paolo Ricci)

Above Everything, God Above Everyone: An Ideational Approach to Jair Bolsonaro's Speeches in His First Year in Government. 78th Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, USA, April 14-18, (*Virtual*)

2019

An informational approach on the composition process of the Constitution, Justice and Citizenship Committee of the Chamber of Deputies. 6th Brazilian Graduate Forum of Political Science, Belém, Brazil, July 7-12

2014

Democracy in Santa Catarina Schools: Elections for Principals as Perpetuation of Political Nominations. 5th Undergraduate National Meeting and 4th National Conference of PIBID, Natal, Brazil, December 8-12

Awards, Grants, and Fellowships

Fall 2026
Travel Grant. Conference funding. Stetson University (US$2000).

Research Grant. Edward's Fund. Stetson University (US$4,166).

Research Grant. Institute for Humane Studies (US$5000). (With Flávia Batista da Silva and Ozlem Tuncel Gurlek)

Summer 2026
Summer Grant. Stetson University (US$7000).

Fall 2025
Travel Grant. Conference funding. Stetson University (US$1850).

Spring 2025
Bridging Barriers: AI-Driven Research on Populism, Authoritarianism, and Far-Right Frames Across Global Contexts. Global Forum on Democracy and Development Cross-Hub Collaboration Fund. (with Francesca Chiarvesio, Cláudia Araújo, Gennadii Iakovlev, Eduardo Tamaki, Didem Seys, and Lisa Zanotti). (US$20,000).

Fall 2024
CAPES Thesis Award. Best Political Science and International Relations PhD Dissertation, Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education Personnel (CAPES). *Postdoctoral Position in Brazil (R$62,400)*

Spring 2024
Travel Grant. Conference funding. Skidmore College (US$1850).

Fall 2023
Research Grant. Grant for research-related expenses. Skidmore College (US$500).

Spring 2022
Travel Grant. Conference funding. University of São Paulo (US$800).

Fall 2021
Study Abroad: Internationalization Program. Under the supervision of David Plotke (The New School for Social Research). Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education Personnel (CAPES) (US$13,300).

2018-2022
Ph.D. Fellowship, National Council for the Scientific and Technological Development (CNPq) (R$124,800).

Spring 2020
Teaching Assistant Fellowship, University of São Paulo (R$ 4,110).

2016-2018
M.A. Fellowship, Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education Personnel (CAPES) (R$36,000).

2014-2015
Research Assistant Fellowship, National Council for the Scientific and Technological Development (CNPq) (R$9,000).

Fall 2014
Travel Grant. Conference funding. Federal University of Santa Catarina (R$1400).

2012-2014
Teaching Training Fellowship, Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education Personnel (CAPES) (R$9,000).

Talks and Guest Lectures

Guest Lecture: Yeshiva University, Political Science Department. *Populism in the US*. Fall 2025.

Guest Lecture: Yeshiva University, Political Science Department. *Populism and Democratic Backsliding*. Fall 2025.

Talk: Federal University of Santa Catarina, Political Science and Sociology Department. *Populism or Impeachment? Explaining Brazilian Democratic Backsliding*. Fall 2024.

Guest Lecture: Yeshiva University, Political Science Department. *Populism in Brazil: Leadership and Parties*. Spring 2024.

Guest Lecture: Yeshiva University, Political Science Department. *Bolsonaro: Populism and Democratic Backsliding*. Spring 2024.

Guest Lecture: Yeshiva University, Political Science Department. *Bolsonaro: Populism and Democratic Backsliding*. Fall 2023.

Guest Lecture: Manhattan Marymount College, Political Science Department. *Populism in Brazil: From Vargas to Bolsonaro*. Fall 2022.

Reviewed for

Brazilian Political Science Review, Politics, Revista Brasileira de Ciência Política, Routledge, Bloomsbury Publishing, PLOS ONE, Populism, International Journal of Communication

Media Appearences

How Brazilian Democracy Survived. Op-ed for *Review of Democracy* (*Forthcoming*). (with Paolo Rici and Gabriel Pinho)

Do que precisamos para conter um populista autoritário?. Op-ed *Nexo*. (with Paolo Rici and Gabriel Pinho)

A crise democrática e a democracia militante. Glossary for *Nexo*. (with Paolo Rici and Gabriel Pinho)

Comment on the runoff of the 2022 Brazilian Elections for *Razón de Estado*

Comment on the first round of the 2022 Brazilian Elections for *Razón de Estado*

Training

Synthetic Control Method. Mixtape Workshop (with Alberto Abadie, Massachusetts Institute of Technology)

Causal Inference. Mixtape Workshop (with Scott Cunningham, Baylor University)

Basic Statistics. (with Matthijs Rooduin and Emiel van Loon, University of Amsterdam)

Content Analysis. Compolítica Summer School - National Institute of Science and Technology in Digital Democracy (with Rafael Correia Sampaio, Federal University of Paraná)

Data mining and Language Processing in R. Compolítica Summer School - National Institute of Science and Technology in Digital Democracy (with Cristtian Paixão, Federal University of Bahia)

Introduction to data mining in R. Compolítica Summer School - National Institute of Science and Technology in Digital Democracy (with Cristtian Paixão, Federal University of Bahia)

Introduction to R: Data Analysis for Political Science. (with Jonathan Phillips, University of São Paulo)

Escola de Dados Coda.br 2020

Skills

Languages

Protuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)

Statistics and Programming

Advanced user in R, LaTeX, and Qualtrics

Membership in Professional Associations

American Political Science Association (APSA), Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA), International Political Science Association (IPSA), Brazilian Political Science Association (ABCP), Brazilian Association of Graduate Studies and Research in Social Sciences (ANPOCS), Latin American Studies Association (LASA), Brazilian Studies Association (BRASA)

References

Paolo Ricci (University of São Paulo)
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dplotke@newschool.edu.

Patricio Navia (New York University)
patricio.navia@nyu.edu.

David Hill (Stetson University)
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ntaylor@skidmore.edu.

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kirk_hawkins@byu.edu.

Levente Littvay (HUN-REN)
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Joseph Luders (Yeshiva University)
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